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r/ucla • 8y ago

BatManatee MIMG '13 and PhD '20



The Redditors' Unofficial Guide to UCLA 2018

Welcome to campus new Bruins! As the school year is upon us, we have a tradition for older and former students to impart some wisdom about UCLA that comes from experience. Here's a [past thread](#) for inspiration.

Other Bruins, please help me share some things you wish that you knew when you started at UCLA! Whether that's which classes are best, how to life with roommates, how to make friends, what are the best restaurants in town, or anything else that you think would help our new students!

I'll start things off with my comment from a previous iteration.



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BatManatee MOD • 8y ago • Edited 8y ago

MIMG '13 and PhD '20

Some of my favorite restaurants in Westwood are:

Bella Pita--a great pita place owned by a UCLA prof

Fat Sal's--massive sandwiches that are awful for you but great after a few drinks

Ike's Sandwiches--Somewhat overpriced, but amazing sandwiches

800 degrees--One of the build your own pizza places

Pinche's Tacos--Hands down the best traditional Mexican food in Westwood. Their carne asada fries are great and I really like their mole. It's on the pricier side but they give a 10% discount with student IDs.

TLT--Non-traditional taco place but pretty good. Also a bit overpriced.

Emporium Thai--Across Wilshire, so it's a bit of a hike to get there, but it's my favorite Thai spot in the area. I go with the Panang Curry.

Also not in Westwood but nearby, Plan Check has the best burgers in town (Father's Office is also amazing but I prefer Plan Check). They're high end and expensive, but absolutely worth it.



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responsibility now. And pay attention. You're paying to be there, use your time efficiently.

Study hard, you're probably used to being one of the smartest people in your high school. Just like everyone else at UCLA. You compensate for the harder competition by working harder. I did not take this seriously and when I first came to UCLA and I got my first C ever by bombing the first college final I ever took. It did kick my ass into shape, though.

Don't be afraid to talk to professors, they're just people, and most will be glad that you're interested in their class enough to approach them. NEVER ask for extra credit (it does not exist in 99% of college classes). And as a TA, use us for help! I want to help all my students but some aren't comfortable asking for it. Office hours are the best chance for me to interact with people personally.

We have a huge student body, as I'm sure you know. That is mostly a great thing, but it has a downside too. It means there is also something to do or someone to hang out with, but it means you can get lost in the herd if you don't put in the effort. During your first few weeks, go to EVERYTHING you're invited to, even if you're not interested. Most of the people you hang out with in the first few weeks aren't people you will stay close with for the rest of college. The only person I met that didn't enjoy UCLA couldn't figure this step out. She kept expecting fun to find her instead of making it happen.

There is no easier time to make friends in your entire life than the first few weeks of freshman year. EVERYONE is scared. EVERYONE is alone. Approach random people on your floor, in your classes, in clubs, and talk to them.

Buy a Den pass, it's worth it. Go to all sort of the sporting events you can. Football games eat up most of a day, but they were one of my favorite things (even though our team is terrible this year). I still go to a few home games a year.

During finals week, don't go to Powell to study. Every freshman thinks of it as THE UCLA library and it's the first place they go, so it is insanely crowded. There are like 10 other libraries on campus that you can go to and actually find somewhere to sit. My secret spot has always been the small library in the Geology building. A lot of people don't know it exists.

57

Reply

[\[deleted\]](#) · 8y ago

No Chick-fil-A and In n Out?

13

Reply

BatManatee OP · 8y ago

MIMG '13 and PhD '20

When I initially made the list a while back, I tried to avoid the big chains because everyone already knows about them even though both of those places are great.

I just added a couple more to it: Pinche's Tacos and Emporium Thai.

13

Reply



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Reply

BatManatee OP • 8y ago

MIMG '13 and PhD '20

That's a good one. I'm partial to Killer Noodle on Sawtelle personally.

6

Reply

**turtlehobopirate** • 8y ago

UCLA PhD '27

Pieology and Open Oven both closed down. Blaze opened up on campus in bomb shelter (south campus food area). 800 degrees has a pizza of the day deal on weekdays for \$6 (pizza of the day posted on [their instagram](#) every weekday) and when the potd is good is pretty much the only time I ever get 800.

5

Reply

BatManatee OP • 8y ago • Edited 8y ago

MIMG '13 and PhD '20

Good catch! I should have checked over my old comment a bit more! I miss open oven, it was one of my favorites. But blaze is pretty good. I wonder if that King of New York pizza place is good? Haven't made it there yet.

2

Reply

**LegitosaurusRex** • 8y ago

Great list. I'd add the Fresh Corn Grill for great salmon tacos and grilled corn and other veggies.

3

Reply

**beepusgee** • 8y ago

House of Meatballs is another fantastic restaurant. Fresh, handmade pasta for reasonable prices, even on a college budget. The wait staff and owners are amazing too

3

Reply

**esameraguy** • 8y ago

Is that Indian place across from whole foods still open? I remember it being pretty damn good, but a bit pricey

2

Reply

BatManatee OP • 8y ago

MIMG '13 and PhD '20

As far as I know it is, but I haven't been in years. I think a few years back they changed ownership (or at least the name) from Bombay Bite to Bollywood Bite or something like that.

There's also a couple of other good Indian places nearby: India's Oven, and Maharaja. It's been a while since I've been to any of them, but I remember liking all of them. I think Maharaja was the cheapest and the manager at India's Oven was very nice to us, chatted with us and



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**FuckVerticalView** • 8y ago

EE '03

advice: don't buy a den pass because it's expensive and theres a thousand other ways to have fun

1

Reply

**BatManatee** OP • 8y ago

MIMG '13 and PhD '20

Fair enough. Your mileage may vary. But for me when I was an undergrad, my fun to cost ratio was excellent, I never regretted buying it. But you're right, there are lots of other ways to have fun too!

2

Reply

SirVataqun • 8y ago

The best place to shit is in Kerckhoff. The men's restroom is pretty well hidden but oh my god is it nice to shit there. Low light, away from lots of student traffic, and best of all, it is cleaned regularly since mostly faculty and staff use this facility.

If you have other nice shitting locations, feel free to share.

44

Reply

manaroth54 • 8y ago

Haines bottom floor is always a great option, and it's pretty accessible from most buildings.

15

Reply

**allieeggs** • 8y ago

'20

I'm partial to the bathrooms in the Schoenberg music building in between north and south campus. They're well-maintained, clean, and look very nice.

If you're not quite to class yet, level A of Ackerman and Kaufman are both good options. The rest of the Ackerman bathrooms are nasty though.

6

Reply

cbj950613 • 8y ago

The best shitting location is Gloria Kaufman 1F bathrooms

3

Reply

[deleted] • 8y ago

But have you been to Kerckhoff at night? It's creepy as shit

3

Reply



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Physics and Astronomy building (PAB) is pretty good too 🤔

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Reply

**FuckVerticalView** • 8y ago

EE '03

Humanities (Kaplan Hall now) has good shitters.

1

Reply

**asscreed4life** • 8y ago

SeasCafe. 75c coffee if you bring your own container, and its 50c happy hour from 5-6pm. Great if you drink lots of coffee and dont care how the coffee is. Its super hidden (in Boelter) so usually pretty quiet but theres almost nowhere to sit.

20

Reply

**nuhGIRLyen** • 8y ago

It also has a very distinctive smell. The 8th floor library really smells like SEASCafe coffee during midterms.

2

Reply

BatManatee OP • 8y ago • Edited 8y ago

MIMG '13 and PhD '20

Also to answer a question that gets asked a lot on the subreddit: "How do I get into a research lab?"

First off: I would not recommend trying to find a lab in your first year. Especially not during Fall quarter. My lab typically likes to take students that are midway through their second year or starting their third year (have some college science classes under their belt, but will likely stick around for a couple of years in the lab)

That said, there are two main ways to get into a lab that I know of. The first is if one of your professors or TAs that is teaching a class seems engaging/friendly/doing interesting research, ask them during office hours if they have any opening or know of anyone who does. The second is to go through faculty lists, find a few that seem interesting. Read a couple abstracts about their work. Start emailing. Don't use copy pasted messages--it's obvious and will be ignored. Send the PI a short email (if it's too long they won't read it) introducing yourself and explaining specifically why you're interested in that particular lab. Include your CV (have a friend proofread it).

Go into it knowing a good number of PIs won't respond. A lot of labs like my own get way more undergraduates looking to volunteer than we can manage. As a general rule: email a PI once, if they don't respond, you can do a follow up a week later. If you still don't hear anything, assume it's a no from that PI.

Also: the general rule at UCLA is that you can get either units or money for working in a lab, but not both. The paid positions for undergrads are few and far between and are typically lab maintenance



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they are pass/no pass. 199's are for experienced students in the lab that get their own sub-project under a grad student or postdoc mentor and are expected to work 15-20 hours a week. You get a letter grade (my PI basically always gives students A's as I think most do) and have to submit a report at the end of the quarter.

19

Reply

**TheGuyfromRiften** • 8y ago

Biophysics '21

If you're tired of shit internet, contact Student Tech Center at Covell Commons to set up ethernet in your rooms!

16

Reply

[deleted] • 8y ago

I wish someone had told me not to get discouraged if I don't get accepted into a club/major/internship/job etc. Everyone I know here has been rejected for things, even smart, motivated, kind people. UCLA is competitive. But don't let that stop you from applying. Apply to everything that interests you and you'll probably get something. But don't expect to get into anything you want right away. I also know a fair amount of people who got into a club/program on their second try.

15

Reply

**dontputlabelsonme** • 8y ago

I agree, I was discouraged my freshman fall cause I didn't get into a lot of clubs I applied to but I just applied the next year and it was fine

4

Reply

**PossiblyAsian** • 8y ago

History 19

If u got a triple take the desk on the left. Its got a wall next to it. It hides u from the view of anyone walking in so if u jacking it and your roommate walks into the room.

You got a grace period of 2-4 seconds to hide yo junk and nasty porn.

18

Reply

**Svitax** • 8y ago

Real men assert their dominance and just jack off in the middle of the room. Look them in the eye as they walk in.

26

Reply

[deleted] • 8y ago

I iust want to let all the freshmen know that Ralph's UCLA oot a bar for vou to drink while arocerv



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**And_Falling_Fast** • 8y ago

You do have to be 21 though, so this may not be too helpful for most freshman. Transfers, on the other hand, enjoy!

5

Reply

**BurritosNervosa** • 8y ago

medicine '19

AND a sushi bar!

1

Reply

YetiPie • 8y ago

What! Can you take your beer around while you shop?

1

Reply

**nuhGIRLyen** • 8y ago

No

1

Reply

**FuckVerticalView** • 8y ago

EE '03

you can't rely on CAPS for long-term care, even though it's advertised that it solves all problems

4

Reply

something987654321 • 8y ago

very true! Your mental health is very important and is crucial to succeed, find a way to take care of yourself and get the help you need!

1

Reply

**dontputlabelsonme** • 8y ago

If you're struggling in any of your classes or honestly just want some extra help I would look into joining AAP! You can talk to the office to see if you qualify for what they offer, such as peer learning sessions, counseling and honestly just a solid group of friends as well

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